

stepiii

User Manual 1.2

A performance step sequencer for Monome Grid using iii

Designed by Nollie Gray

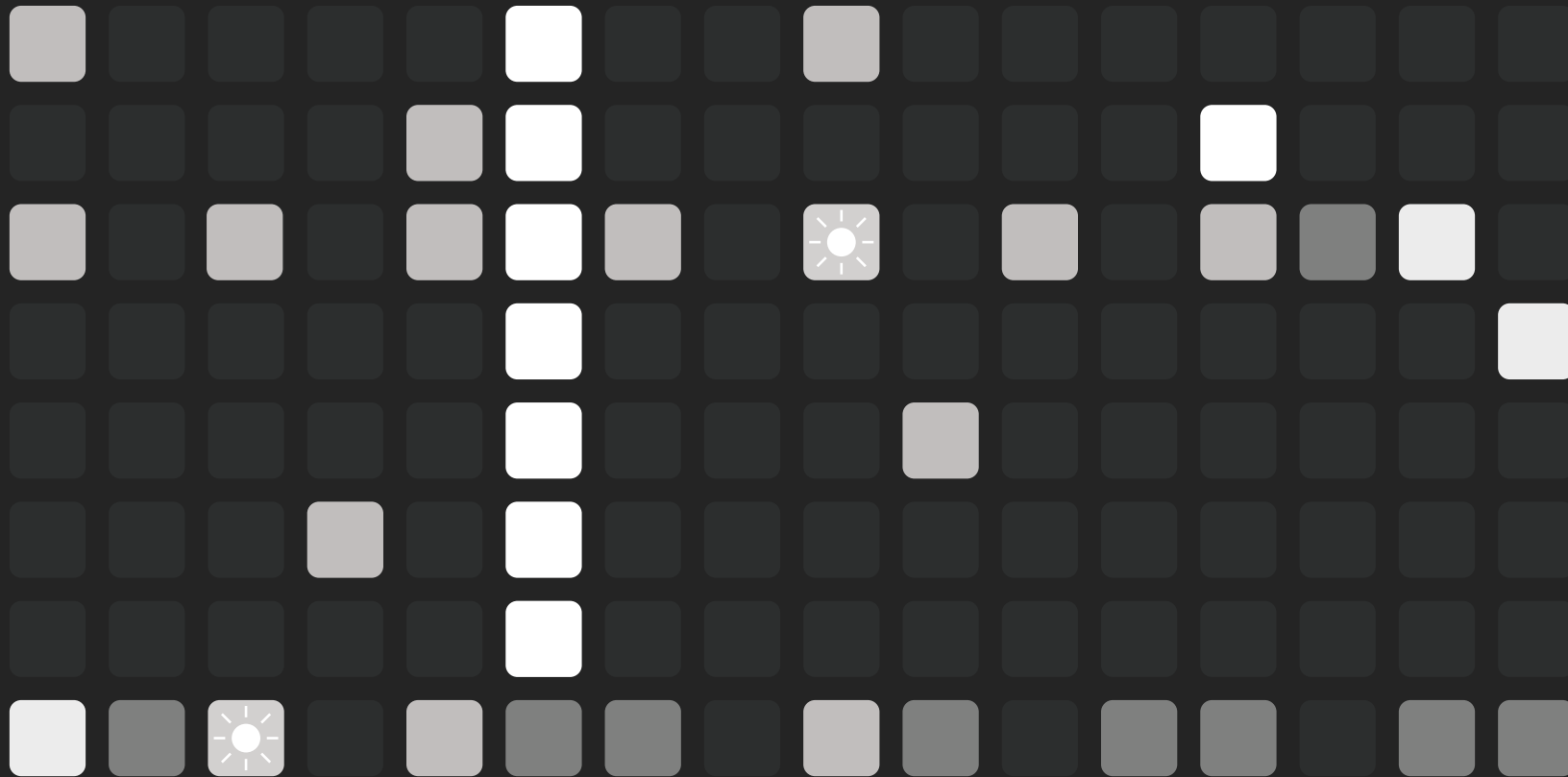
stepiii

Stepiii is an adaptable 7-track 32-step sequencer with live performance in mind. It uses an intuitive UI and workflow to allow for quick pattern adjustments, instant preset swaps, and on-device configuration.

It is designed for drums, but can be equally useful for polyphonic sequences or a combination of instruments on set up on different channels.

Each of the 7 tracks can have independently configurable length, velocity per step, ratchet per step, different amounts of swing, positive or negative offset, MIDI note and MIDI channel.

For performance, it has mutes, preset save and recall per track, tempo note repeat, and a cycling repeat.



Play/Stop Reset Clock Steps 1-16 Steps 17-32 Track Length Velocity Ratchet Swing & Offset Shift Notes & MIDI Perform & Presets

Play/Stop & Reset

[A] Play/Stop

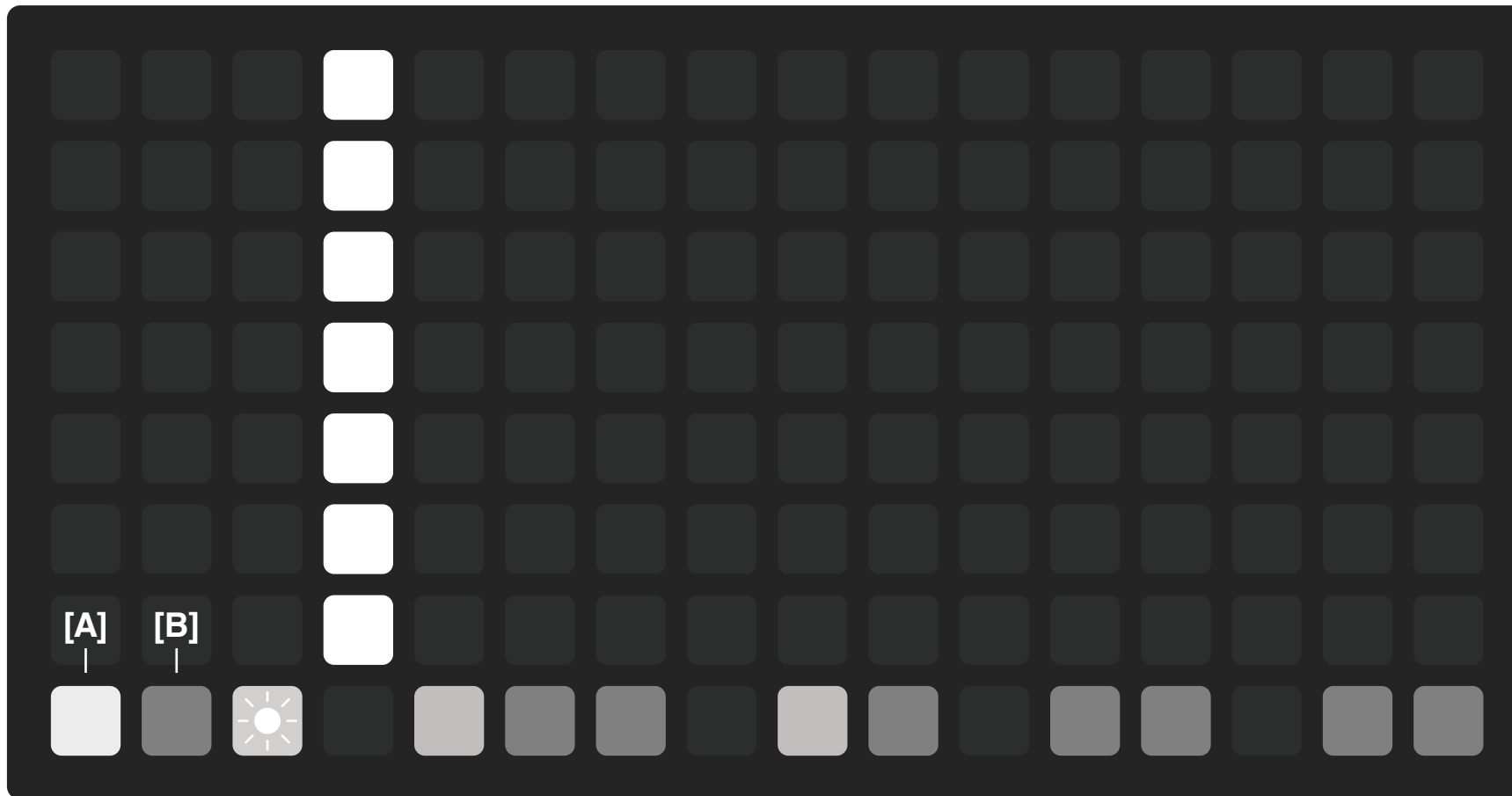
This button starts and stops the sequencer. When clocking externally, this button only functions as a stop. The playhead will move across the grid for each track.

Shortcut:

Holding [A] for 2 seconds will clear the sequence steps and reset all tracks to 16 steps. If you press the first button in a track while holding [A], then just a single track will clear.

[B] Reset

This button resets each track back to the first step. It can be done in either clocking mode.



Play/Stop Reset Clock Steps 1-16 Steps 17-32 Track Length Velocity Ratchet Swing & Offset Shift Notes & MIDI Perform & Presets

[C] Steps 1-16

[D] Steps 17-32

Page Follow

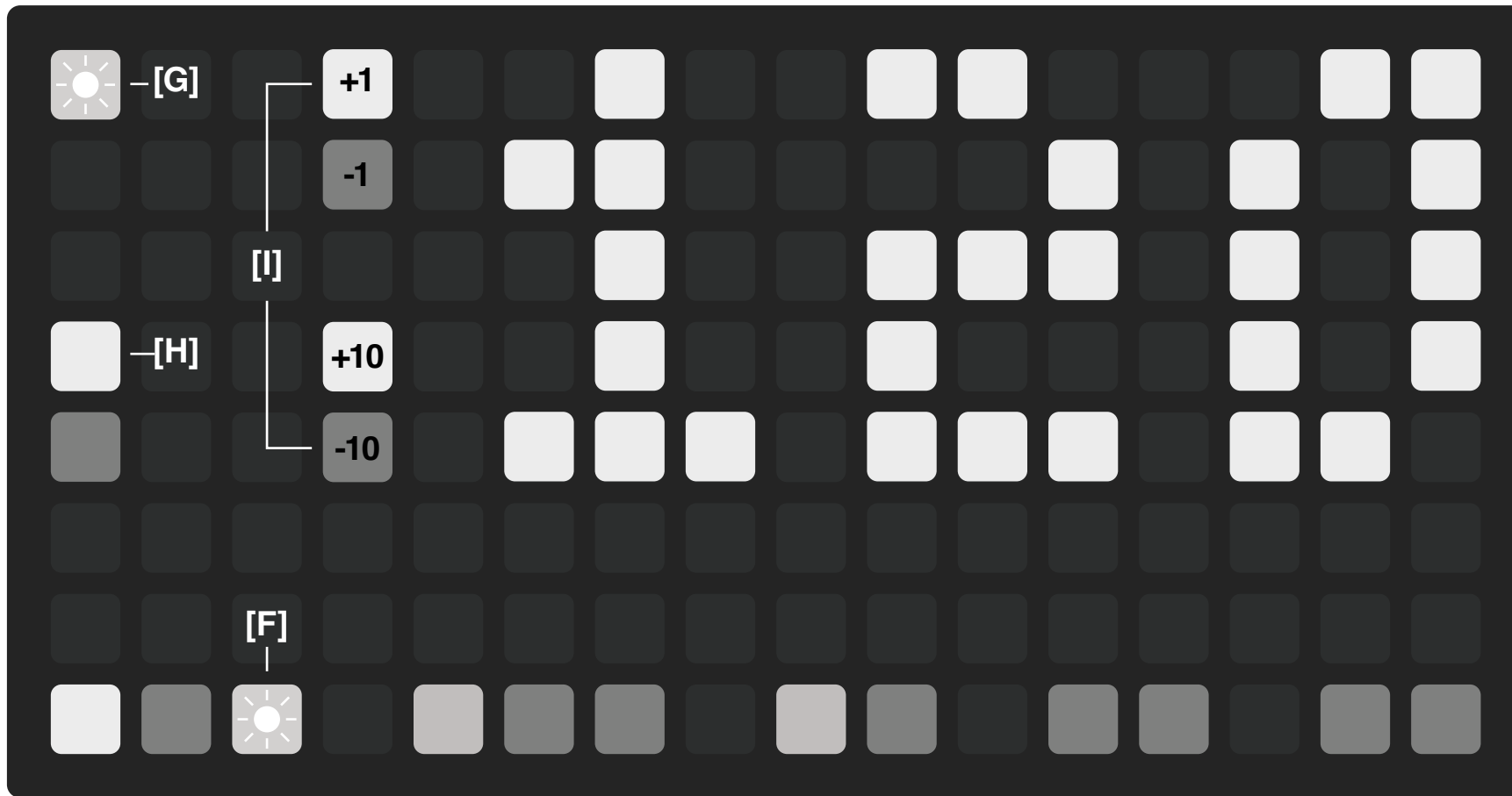
[E] Track Length

Shortcut:

Holding [E] and pressing [C] resets all tracks to 16 steps.

Holding **[E]** and pressing **[D]** resets all tracks to 32 steps.





Clock Internal

[F] Clock

The clock button toggles clock page and blinks at the current tempo.

[G] Tap Tempo

The top left button is the tap tempo. Tap it ~4 times to set the internal tempo.

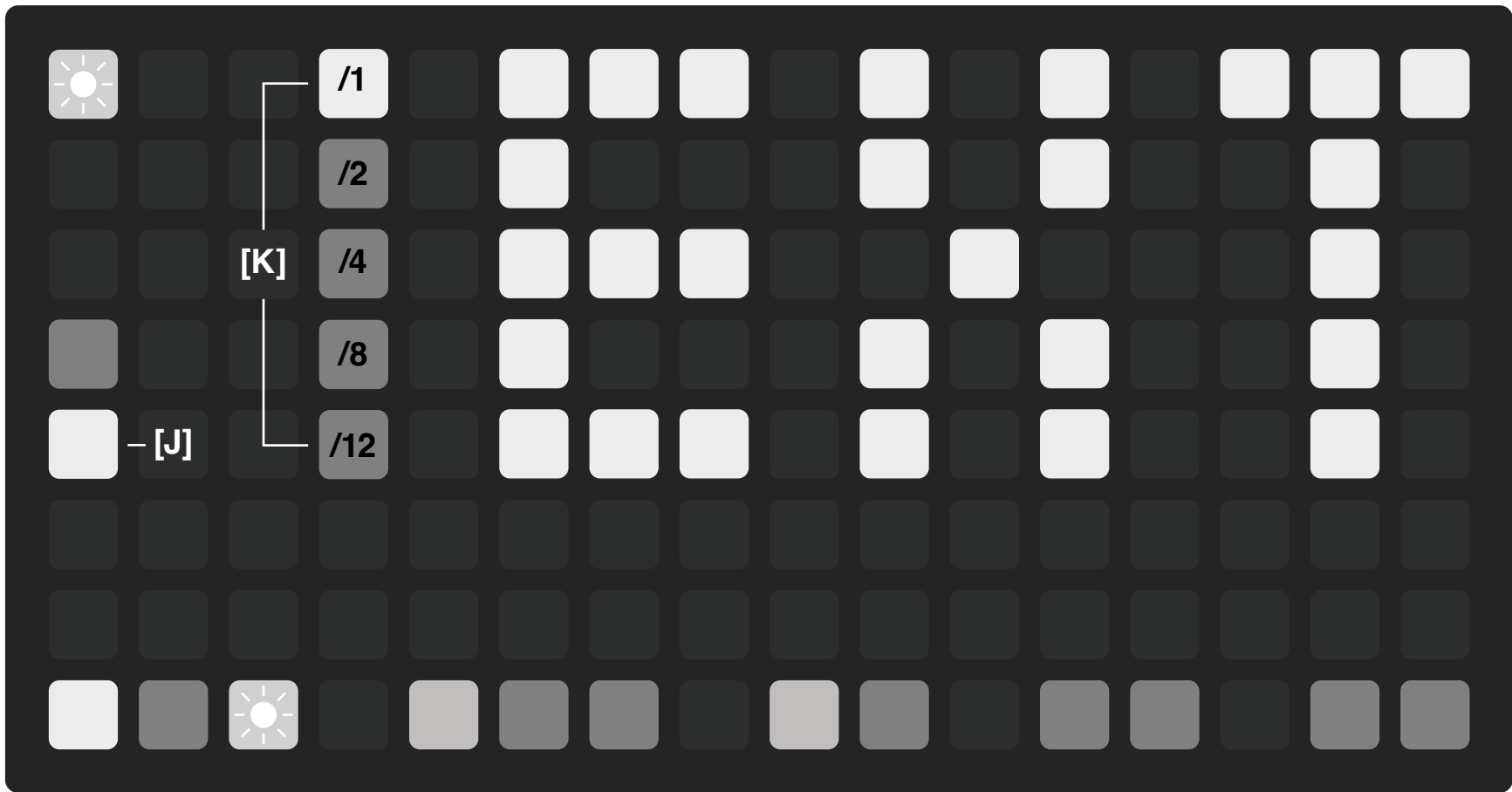
[H] Internal Source

This button selects the internal clock and the BPM displays the current tempo.

[I] Increments

The two sets of buttons next to the BPM display numbers are for increasing or decreasing the tempo.

Play/Stop Reset Clock Steps 1-16 Steps 17-32 Track Length Velocity Ratchet Swing & Offset Shift Notes & MIDI Perform & Presets



Clock External

[J] External MIDI Source

This button sets the clock to look for an external MIDI signal. It responds to start, stop, and reset signals. EXT is now showing instead of the BPM display.

If the clock is set back to internal after using an external, the internal clock will reflect the previously used external clock (approximate).

[K] Clock Divider

The external clock can be divided. The division global for all other time-based events.

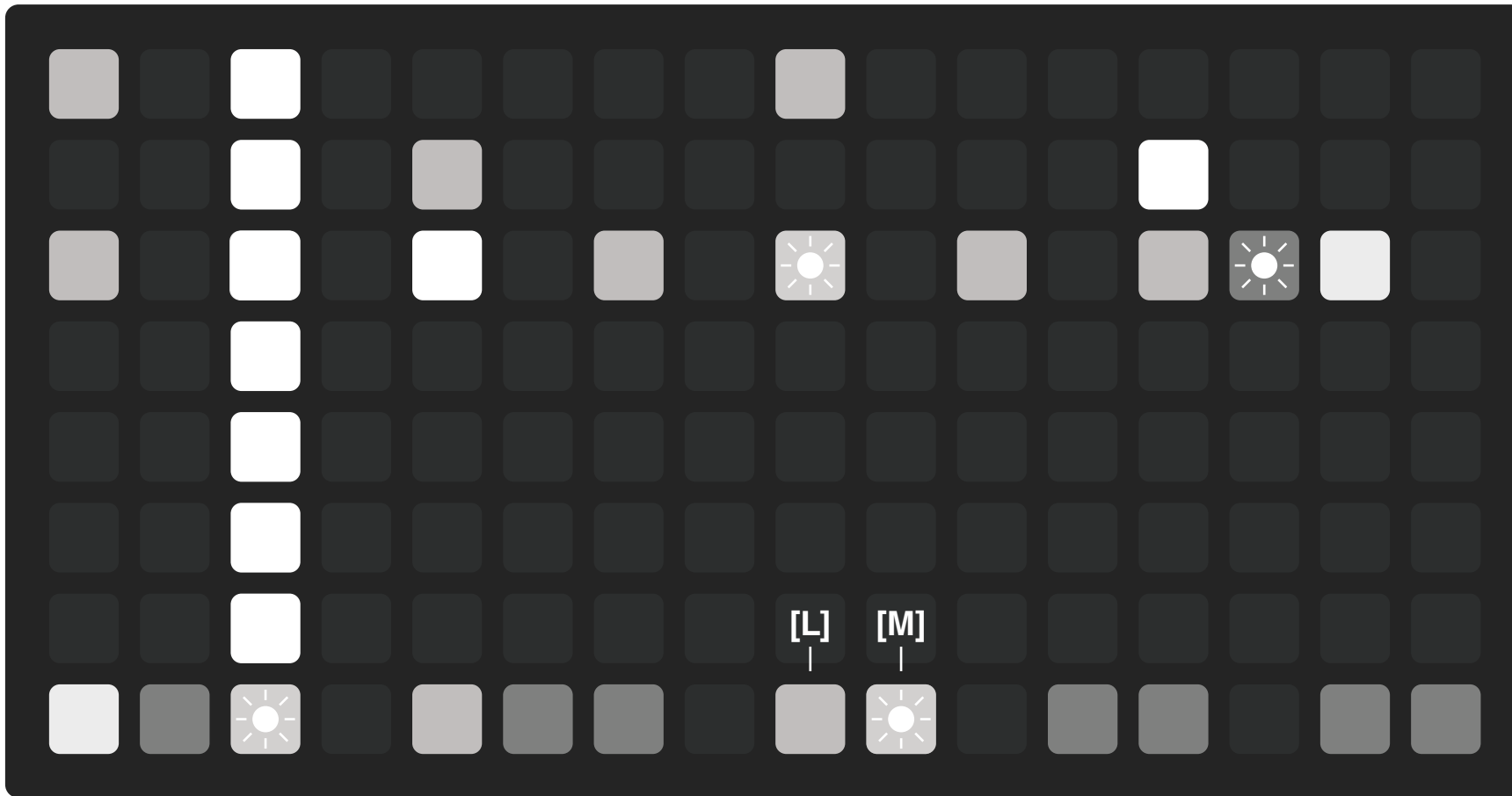
Play/Stop Reset Clock

Steps
1-16 Steps
17-32 Track
Length

Velocity Ratchet

Swing &
Offset Shift

Notes
& MIDI Perform
& Presets



Velocity & Ratchet

[L] Velocity

This button toggles through the velocity levels of the steps being entered on the track. It has four different levels, indicated by brightness:

Dim = 32

Low = 64

Norm = 96

Bright = 127

Steps are shown on the grid at their velocity brightness.

[M] Ratchet

This button toggles the ratchet option for the steps being entered on the track. A step with a ratchet will play two quick notes in the span of the same step with the first being a slightly lower velocity. If a step has a ratchet, the step blinks with the tempo.

Velocity and Ratchets can be applied to the same step.

Shortcut:
Holding [L] or [M] and pressing an existing step will cycle through options of that step without removing it.

Play/Stop Reset Clock

Steps
1-16

Steps
17-32

Track
Length

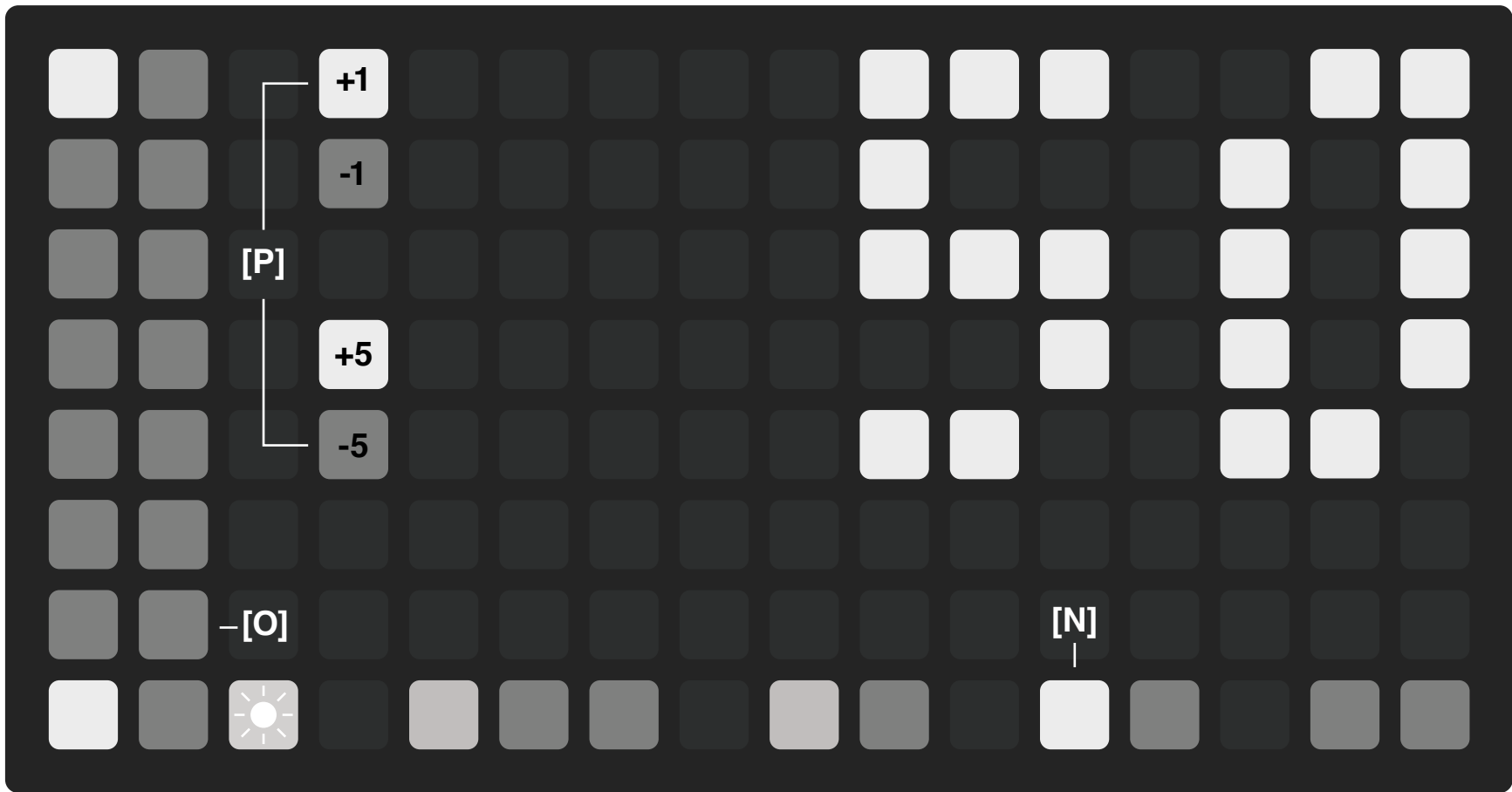
Velocity Ratchet

Swing &
Offset

Shift

Notes
& MIDI

Perform
& Presets



Swing & Offset

[N] Swing & Offset

This button toggles the Swing and Offset page and shows the settings for each track. While each track can have independent swing and offset timings, they apply to all the steps in a track uniformly.

[O] Track/Option Select

The two columns of buttons on the left are for choosing which track and which option you are adjusting. The first column of buttons is for adjusting swing. The second column adjusts the offset.

[P] Increments

The two sets of buttons next to the number display are for increasing or decreasing the swing or offset.

Swing can be adjusted from 50 (no swing) to 75%.

Offset adjustment can range from -50 to +50 milliseconds to play the track early or late.

Shortcut:

Holding [N] and pressing an increment button will change all tracks to match the current value.

Play/Stop Reset Clock

Steps 1-16 Steps 17-32 Track Length

Velocity Ratchet

Swing & Offset Shift

Notes & MIDI Perform & Presets

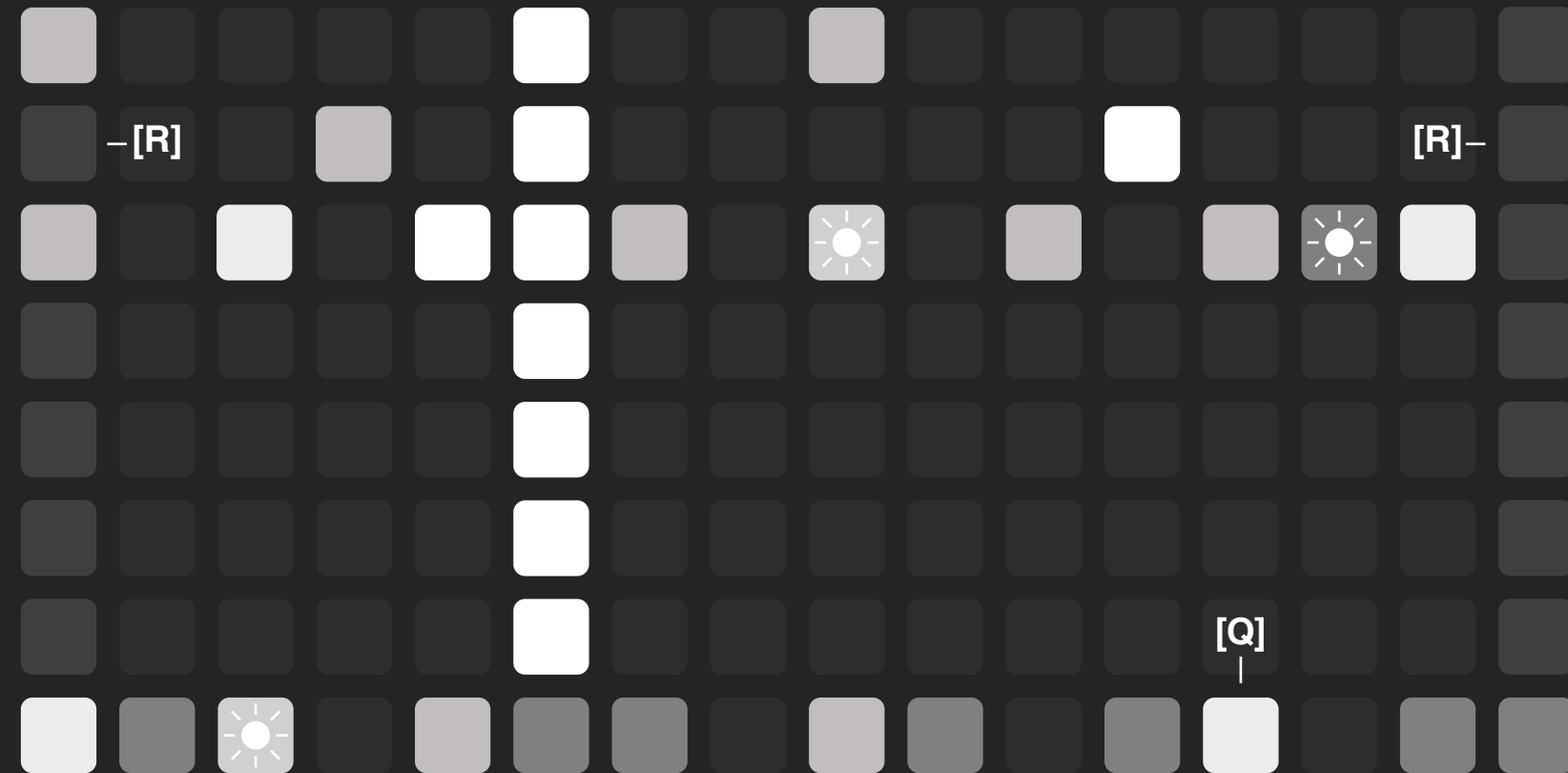
Shift

[Q] Shift

This button toggles the shift feature that lets you move all the steps on a track left or right. While shift is toggled, press the button [R] in either the far left or right column to adjust the steps left or right on that particular track.

Steps at the end of a track will shift back around the start of the track and vice versa.

The shift feature is only applied to the current track length, so steps outside of the current track length will not be shifted. Shift can also occur across track pages if the track length is longer than 16 steps.



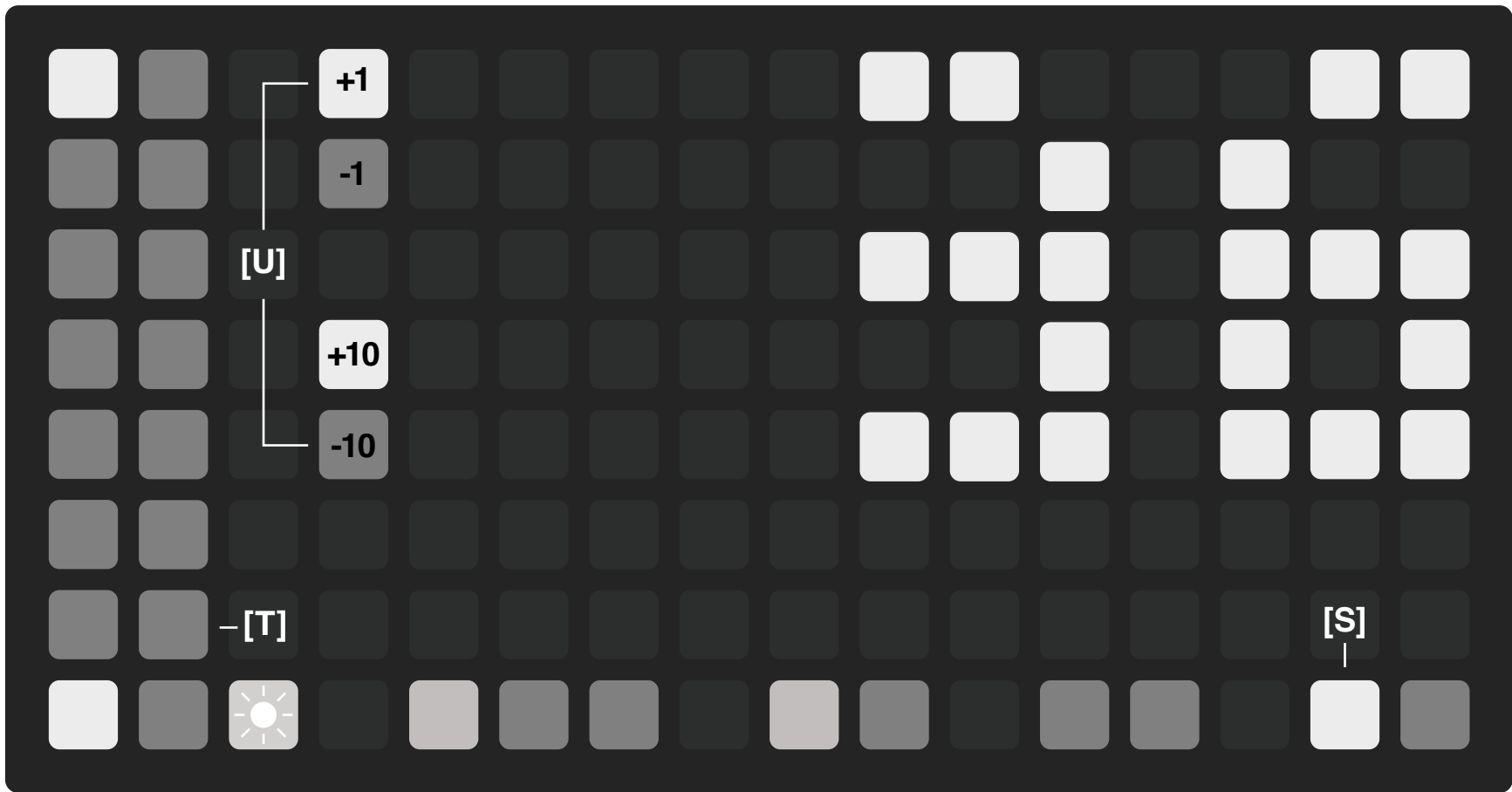
Play/Stop Reset Clock

Steps 1-16 Steps 17-32 Track Length

Velocity Ratchet

Swing & Offset Shift

Notes & MIDI Perform & Presets



Play/Stop Reset Clock

Steps
1-16 Steps
17-32 Track
Length

Velocity Ratchet

Swing &
Offset Shift

Notes
& MIDI Perform
& Presets

Note & MIDI

[S] Notes & MIDI

This button toggles the Notes and MIDI page and shows the settings for each track. Each track can play a different MIDI note and be on a different MIDI channel.

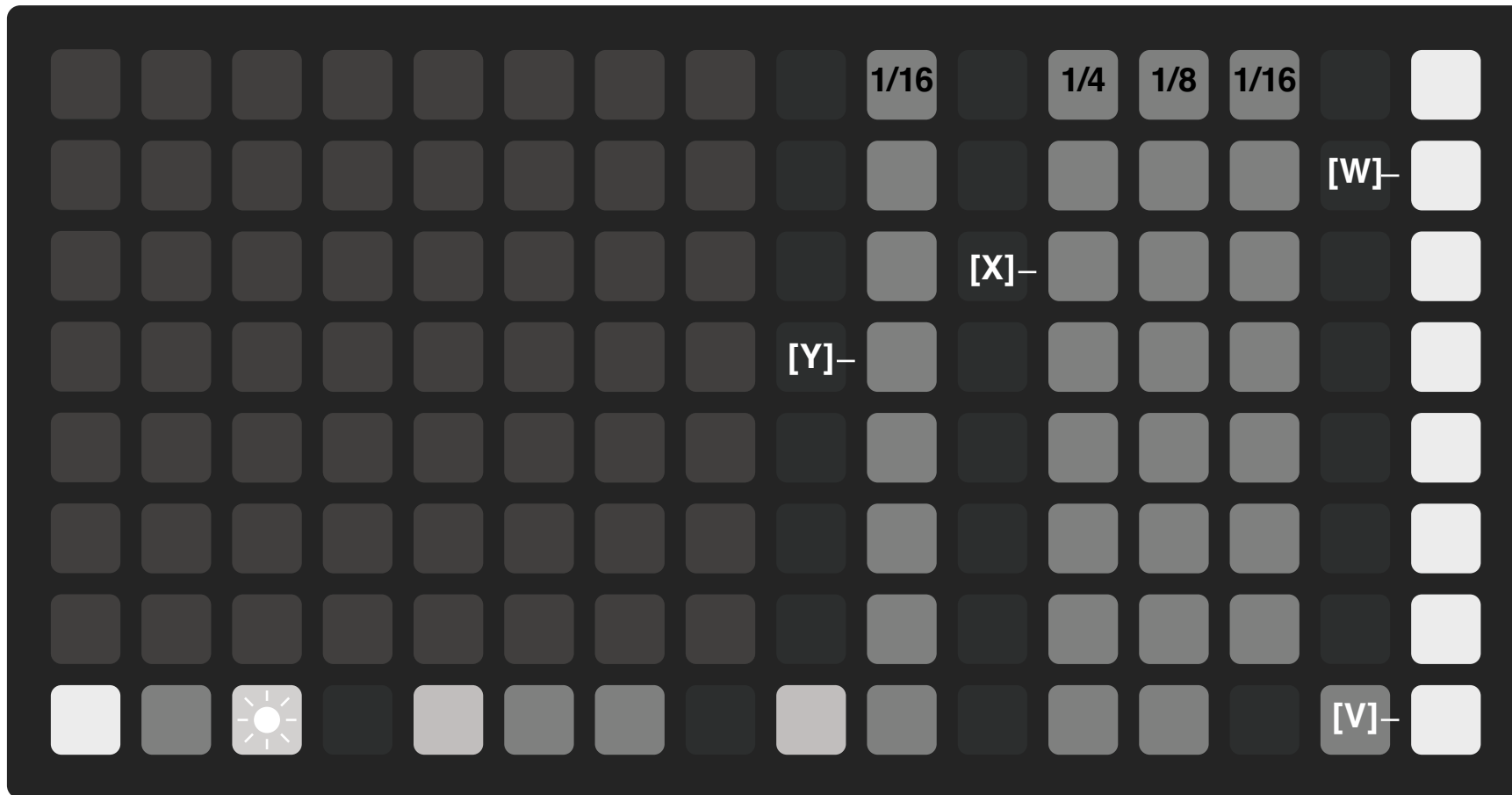
[T] Track/Option Select

The two columns of buttons on the left are for choosing which track and which option you are adjusting. The first column of buttons is for adjusting MIDI note number. The second column adjusts the MIDI channel. These settings are saved with the per-track presets.

[U] Increments

The two sets of buttons next to the number display are for increasing or decreasing the note number or MIDI channel.

MIDI notes can range from 0 to 127 and MIDI channels can range from ALL to 16. The default channel is 10 and tracks 1-7 are: 49, 51, 46, 42, 38, 41, and 36.



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Perform

Mute, Repeats & Cycle

[V] Perform & Presets

This button toggles the Perform and Presets page. Holding [V] and pressing a mute or a preset will toggle all mutes or presets in a column.

[W] Mutes

The far right column is a global mute for each track. A track is muted when its button is off and will play when lit.

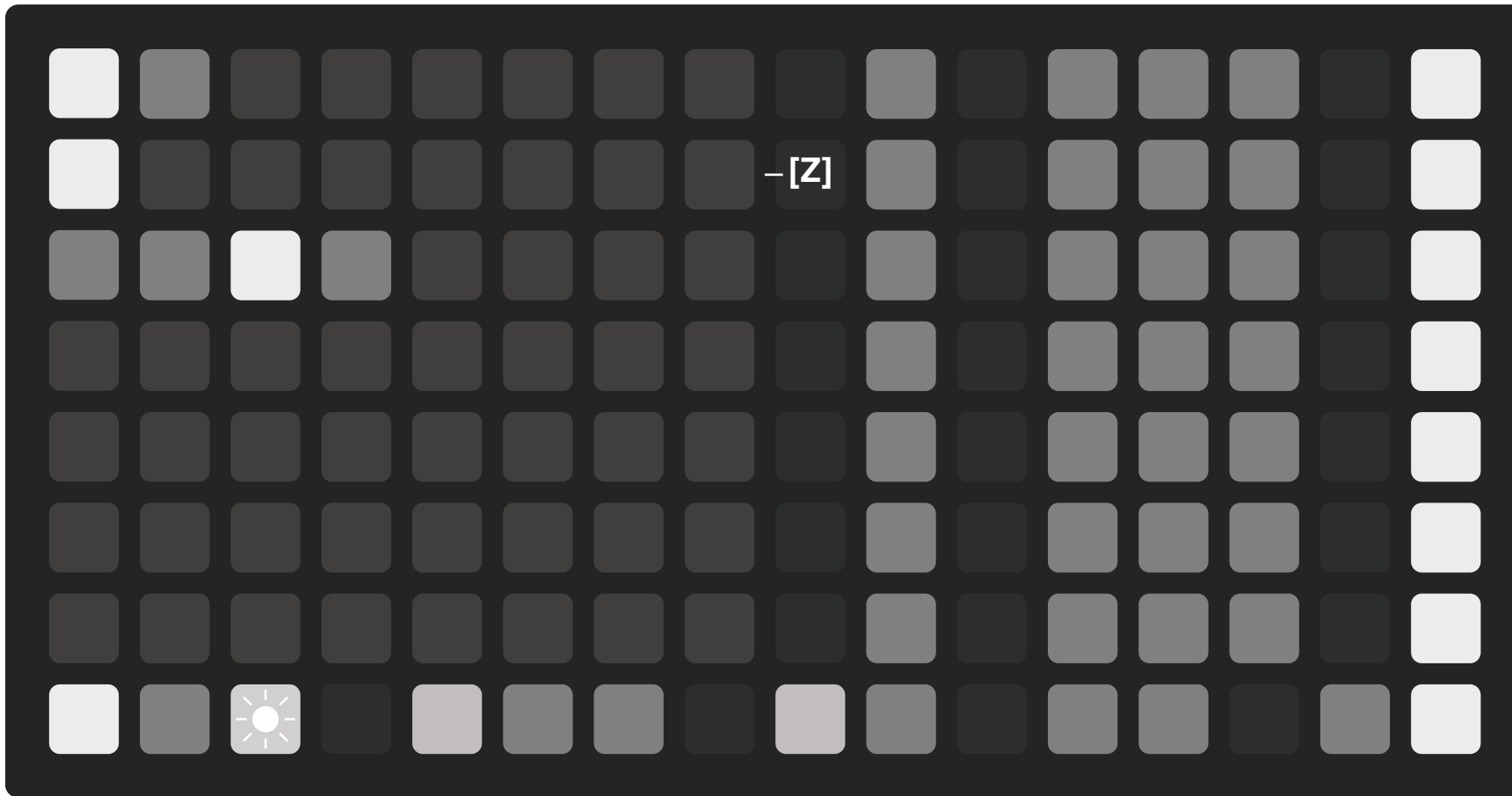
[X] Repeats

The three columns of buttons is the repeats control. One button from each track can be held to have that note repeat at either 1/4, 1/8, or 1/16 notes. Mute states are respected.

[Y] Cycle

This column acts as a 1/16 note repeat, but will cycle through the notes in the order they are held. Mute states are respected like cycles.

For both Repeats and Cycle, the repeats are tied to the BPM, swing, and offset.



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Perform Presets

[Z] Preset Banks

This grid represents the preset slots for the sequencer. Each track can store 8 presets. Slots with no saved preset are dim, and the active preset is lit brightly. Switching between presets is instant and can be used during performance.

Each preset stores the track's steps, velocities, ratchets, mutes, length, swing, offset, MIDI note, and MIDI channel.

To save a preset, hold the slot button for 2 seconds until the slot blinks. Load a preset by tapping the desired button. You can save or load a whole column of presets by holding the [V] button while selecting a preset from [Z].

Presets are numbered based on the row and column. In diii you will see files that look like this:
pset_stepiii_11.lua,
pset_stepiii_21.lua, etc...

Another global preset: *pset_stepiii_100.lua* serves as a global state memory. It recalls your last used BPM and which presets were last loaded. It is updated when pressing any preset button.